

Craft your own AR Experiences

While virtual reality offers experiences that can transport you to an entirely different location, the promise of augmented reality is to transport virtual experiences to your location. Augmented reality experiences such as Pokemon Go or Kazooloo have demonstrated the universal appeal of AR experiences. There have been almost no viral successes on the same scale when it comes to VR, mostly because of the costly nature of the gear and the very fact that you need to totally plug off from the real world. Even run of the mill games such as Hungry Dragons have begun to incorporate AR components within the titles. The writing is on the wall, AR is much more popular than VR.

Considering the ubiquity of mobile phones, we have focussed only on that platform for the tutorials outlined in this Fast Track. Now, when it comes to actually crafting AR experiences, your imagination is the limit. The actual heavy lifting when it comes to ensuring that your digital assets are appropriately positioned, sized and manipulated in virtual experiences are done by developer frameworks for AR experiences maintained by Google and Apple. These frameworks are called ARCore and ARKit respectively. Both platforms are equally capable, and any differences between the two, when it comes to the end result, are relatively minor.

Google did have a more advanced framework for AR experiences, called Google Tango. It was a dedicated platform for AR, which required the devices to incorporate specialised hardware. There were very few devices released with this specialised hardware, such as the ASUS Zenfone AR and the Lenovo Phab 2 Pro. The Tango platform was absorbed by ARCore in 2017.